

DETROIT LIONS

INTEL REPORT

2026 training camp edition — a retooled offensive line, a new offensive coordinator and one central question hanging over Allen Park: has the Super Bowl window closed?

UPDATED
July 25, 2026

Dan Campbell

HEAD COACH

Brad Holmes

GENERAL MANAGER

Drew Petzing

NEW OC

Goff / Gibbs

OFFENSIVE CORE

Missed

2025 EXPECTATIONS

FRONT OFFICE & LEADERSHIP

- New offensive coordinator.** Detroit hired **Drew Petzing** to run the offense — the latest coordinator turnover of the Dan Campbell era, and the most consequential given how far the 2025 season fell short of expectations.
- Campbell and Holmes both back.** The head coach/GM pairing survived a disappointing 2025 intact, but the roster around them was reshaped aggressively rather than preserved.
- Holmes' stated approach:** re-sign the players he already knows fit the culture — CB Rock Ya-Sin and LB Malcolm Rodriguez headlined that group — then fill gaps with mid-tier veterans rather than top-of-market strikes.

TRADES & MAJOR TRANSACTIONS

- TRADE** **David Montgomery to Houston.** The veteran back who formed half of Detroit's signature committee was dealt to the Texans, ending the Montgomery–Gibbs pairing.
- RELEASED** **Taylor Decker and Graham Glasgow** both cut loose as Detroit tore down and rebuilt an offensive line that had been the team's identity.
- SIGNED** **Isiah Pacheco, RB** — the splashiest addition of the offseason and Montgomery's direct replacement. Two-time Super Bowl champion in Kansas City, but coming off two injury-impacted seasons.
- SIGNED** **C Cade Mays, T** **Larry Borom** and **G Ben Barch** — the offensive line reset in three moves.
- SIGNED** **TE Tyler Conklin, CB Roger McCreary, DB Christian Izien, S Chuck Clark, CB Avonte Maddox, QB Teddy Bridgewater, EDGE D.J. Wonnum** (1 yr, up to \$6M).
- RE-SIGNED** **CB Rock Ya-Sin and LB Malcolm Rodriguez.**
- LOST** **NT DJ Reader** to the New York Giants; **QB Kyle Allen** to Buffalo (2 yr / \$6.1M).

RUMOR MILL

- SPECULATION** **"Has the window closed?"** is the framing national outlets have attached to this camp. From 2023–25 Detroit opened every season as a legitimate contender; 2025 ended well short, and the offseason churn read as a response to that.
- SPECULATION** The **safety room** is the quiet worry — a tandem that powered the 2023 run now carries real availability questions into a season Detroit can't afford to waste.

PLAYER UPDATES & CAMP BATTLES

- Penei Sewell, OT.** Voted the NFL's **No. 1 offensive tackle** in an ESPN poll of executives, coaches and scouts — and now moving from right tackle to **left**, the single biggest technical adjustment on the roster.
- Jared Goff, QB.** Back under a new coordinator in Petzing. The core he throws to is intact, which is why Detroit's offense still projects as one of the league's most explosive.
- Jahmyr Gibbs, RB.** No longer splitting with Montgomery. How much of that vacated workload he absorbs — versus Pacheco — is the offense's defining camp question.
- Amon-Ra St. Brown & Jameson Williams, WR.** Both return, giving Goff continuity at receiver even as the line and backfield turn over.
- Isiah Pacheco, RB.** Health is the whole story. Two injury-shortened seasons in Kansas City preceded this deal.
- Offensive line, rebuilt.** With Decker and Glasgow gone and Sewell sliding left, Detroit is auditioning a substantially new five-man front in camp.
- Safety tandem.** Both starters carry serious availability concerns into 2026 — a unit that was a strength is now a question.

LATEST ROSTER MOVES

MOVE	DETAIL
▲ Isiah Pacheco, RB	Free-agent signing — replaces Montgomery
▲ Cade Mays, C	Signed to start the OL rebuild
▲ Larry Borom & Ben Barch	Tackle and guard depth added
▲ Tyler Conklin, TE	Veteran signing
▲ McCreary, Izien, Clark, Maddox	Secondary overhaul in free agency
▲ Ya-Sin & Rodriguez	Re-signed by Holmes
▼ David Montgomery, RB	Traded to Houston Texans
▼ Taylor Decker, OT	Released
▼ Graham Glasgow, G	Released
▼ DJ Reader, NT	Signed with the New York Giants

THE BOTTOM LINE

Detroit answered a disappointing 2025 by changing everything except the people in charge: new coordinator, new line, new backfield partner, same Campbell and Holmes. The skill core — Goff, Gibbs, St. Brown, Williams — is good enough to carry an explosive offense, but it now sits behind a front five that has to be assembled in real time, with **Sewell learning left tackle on the fly**. If the line settles early, the window is still open. If it doesn't, this becomes the season the national narrative already wrote.